

BODY DECODE • FOUR PATTERNS

The Insulin Tells

The full set, and the four things that mean it is not insulin at all.

The post gave you four. Here is the whole list.

And more importantly, how to tell insulin apart from the three other things that look just like it.

Insulin gets blamed for everything and spotted almost never. Blamed for everything, because anyone with a soft middle gets told it is the carbs. Spotted almost never, because the real sign is on your **back**, and nobody thinks to check their back.

Read this before the list. One of these on its own means nothing.

They only mean something together. Three or four of them lining up is worth paying attention to. One of them is just a Tuesday.

1 Signs in your day

Insulin is about how your body handles food. So the clearest signs are about *when* things happen, not what you see in the mirror.

Tick the ones that are actually you. Be honest, not hopeful.

- ☐ **You hit a wall between 2 and 4pm.** And it has nothing to do with how you slept. Eight hours and you still lose the afternoon.
- ☐ **You go heavy and foggy for an hour after eating.** Especially after lunch. Not full. Not sleepy. Just slowed right down.
- ☐ **The cravings come after dinner.** When the day is done and you have got nothing left to fight them with.
- ☐ **You are hungry again soon after a proper meal.** Like it did not count.
- ☐ **You sometimes feel sharper on a day you barely ate than a day you ate properly.** A strange thing to notice about yourself, and one of the clearest signs here.
- ☐ **The same meal hits differently depending on when you eat it.** Rice at lunch with chicken and veg is fine. The same rice on its own at 9pm is not.

2 Signs in where it sits

- ☐ **It is on your back.** Mid-back, lower back, your sides, the love handles. The front of your stomach stays comparatively flat.

- ☐ **Your waist is firm and full, not soft.** Different layer of fat, and it is the deeper one that goes with insulin.

THE SIGNAL THAT DECIDES IT

Your back, not your front.

This is the one almost everybody misses. Everyone checks the front in the mirror. Researchers can predict insulin problems from a pinch of fat on the mid-back better than from a scan of your belly.

It takes four seconds to check and almost nobody does it.

And the bit people get wrong. Going soft evenly all over is *not* an insulin sign. That kind of general softness sits in a completely different layer. If your honest answer is “it is fairly even, I could not pick one spot”, this is not your pattern, and it is probably not much of anything based on where it sits alone.

3 Signs in how your body responds

- ☐ **Cutting carbs hard works for about a week, then stops.** And it all comes back when you stop.
- ☐ **A short walk after a meal makes a bigger difference than it should.** Ten or fifteen minutes should not change how you feel that much. On this pattern it does.
- ☐ **The cravings feel physical, not mental.** That is not you being weak. That is a signal.

Add up your ticks. Out of 11.

- 0 to 2** — not this one. Something else is driving it.
- 3 to 5** — worth taking seriously.
- 6 or more** — insulin is very likely in the mix. Read the next page before you commit to it.

One for your GP, not for a checklist. Skin tags, or darker velvety patches in the folds of your neck, armpits or groin, can go along with this. That is a conversation with your doctor, not something to work out from a PDF, and not something to act on from here. It is in this guide so you know to mention it, not so you can score yourself on it.

The four things that mean it is NOT insulin

This is the part the checklists leave out, and it is why people spend a year fixing the wrong thing.

Remember: **four hormones can drive this, and three of them push fat to your middle.** So a bigger middle rules almost nothing out.

IF THIS IS ALSO TRUE	THEN IT IS PROBABLY NOT INSULIN
Your middle is growing while your arms and legs get thinner	That is cortisol. The limbs thinning is its signature, and insulin never does it.
It sits on your hips, bum and outer thighs, or it used to and has been moving toward your middle over the last few years	That is oestrogen. The movement is what decides it, not where it sits now and not your cycle. If your middle has always been your middle, that is cortisol, not this.
Your muscle, strength and drive are dropping as your middle fills, and you are a man	That is testosterone. The tell is the muscle going, not the fat arriving.
Honestly, none of it lines up	Then possibly none of them, which is a real answer. A body that is working well does not fit any of these.

What actually helps

Insulin is the one pattern where “eat a bit less, move a bit more” is genuinely fair. It does respond to that. Which is exactly why a generic plan half works on it and convinces you the plan was fine and you were the problem.

But the bigger lever is **when you eat and what you eat it with, before how much.**

What sits next to the carbs, and what time they land, moves this more reliably than cutting them out does. Cutting them out works for a fortnight. Then you are living a smaller life for the same result.

TRY THIS WEEK

Two things, for one week. Walk ten to fifteen minutes after your biggest meal. And put protein next to your carbs at lunch instead of eating them on their own.

Nothing gets cut. Nothing gets counted. You are not on a diet for the week.

Then check the two tells you ticked hardest, the 3pm wall and the after-dinner cravings. If those move on a week of that, you have learned more about your body than a month of eating less would have told you.

A high score is a strong hint, not an answer. These patterns can change as your body changes, and more than one can be in play at once. Forcing yourself into the closest-looking box is exactly how people end up fixing a problem they do not have.

WANT TO KNOW IF THIS IS ACTUALLY YOURS?

The free **14-Day Body Decode Challenge** asks you some questions on day one, checks eight things against your own starting point on day seven, and tells you your pattern on day fourteen. Which one is running yours, and what to do about that specific one.

Free. Nothing to pay to get your read.

bodyrecode.au/challenge